

2.6 ATTIC AND ROOF DESIGN

Definition: Attic means any habitable space, but not a separate dwelling, contained wholly within a roof above the ceiling line of the storey immediately below, except for minor elements such as dormer windows and the like.

Objectives

- (a) To ensure attic rooms achieve good residential amenity and environmental performance.
- (b) To minimise the impact of attic rooms on the amenity of adjoining properties.
- (c) To allow a variety of roof forms in response to the scale and character of the building and streetscape.

Controls

- (a) Roof design should contribute to the architectural design and the environmental performance of the development.
- (b) Roof design should respond to the streetscape character of the area.
- (c) Alteration and additions must consider existing streetscape and the impact on neighbouring views.
- (d) Contemporary roof forms are permitted to minimise bulk and scale, and respond appropriately to the context.
- (e) An attic must be wholly contained within a pitched roof form; that is a hipped or gabled roof, but not a flat or skillion roof (with the exception of dormer windows).
- (f) An attic must not increase the bulk and height of the roof.
- (g) Attic levels must:
 - (i) Ensure the pitched roof form is the major visual element of the roof and must respond to the context;
 - (ii) Not exceed 50% of the floor area of the floor below;
 - (iii) Not contain independent dwellings and must be accessed via internal stairs only; and
 - (iv) Be naturally ventilated using cross or stack ventilation.
- (h) Attic rooms must have a minimum width of 3m and must have a minimum floor to ceiling height of 2.4m, for at least two thirds of the floor area of the room (refer to Figure 21).
- (i) Dormer windows and skylights are to be less than 50% of the area of the roof elevation.
- (j) Attic additions must not contain a single expansive dormer window. Multiple smaller dormers are preferred where appropriate.
- (k) Where dormer structures are proposed they must:
 - (i) Be secondary to the primary roof structure; and
 - (ii) Be set down a minimum of 300mm from the main ridge line.